trading ships. The Air Force had been founded in the early twentieth century and participated in World War II; it was small, but growing. However, all three had been shaped by British officers and British military practices. Similarly, India's main intelligence agency had been created in the nineteenth century to help the British stay ahead of their enemies.

Thus, the task for the government and for the few Indian military officers of high rank was to transform these colonial forces into national ones (or, as in the case of the Research and Analysis Wing, to build an entirely new agency) with new priorities and responsibilities alongside keeping the nation secure. The following pages feature some of the remarkable men who helped accomplish this.